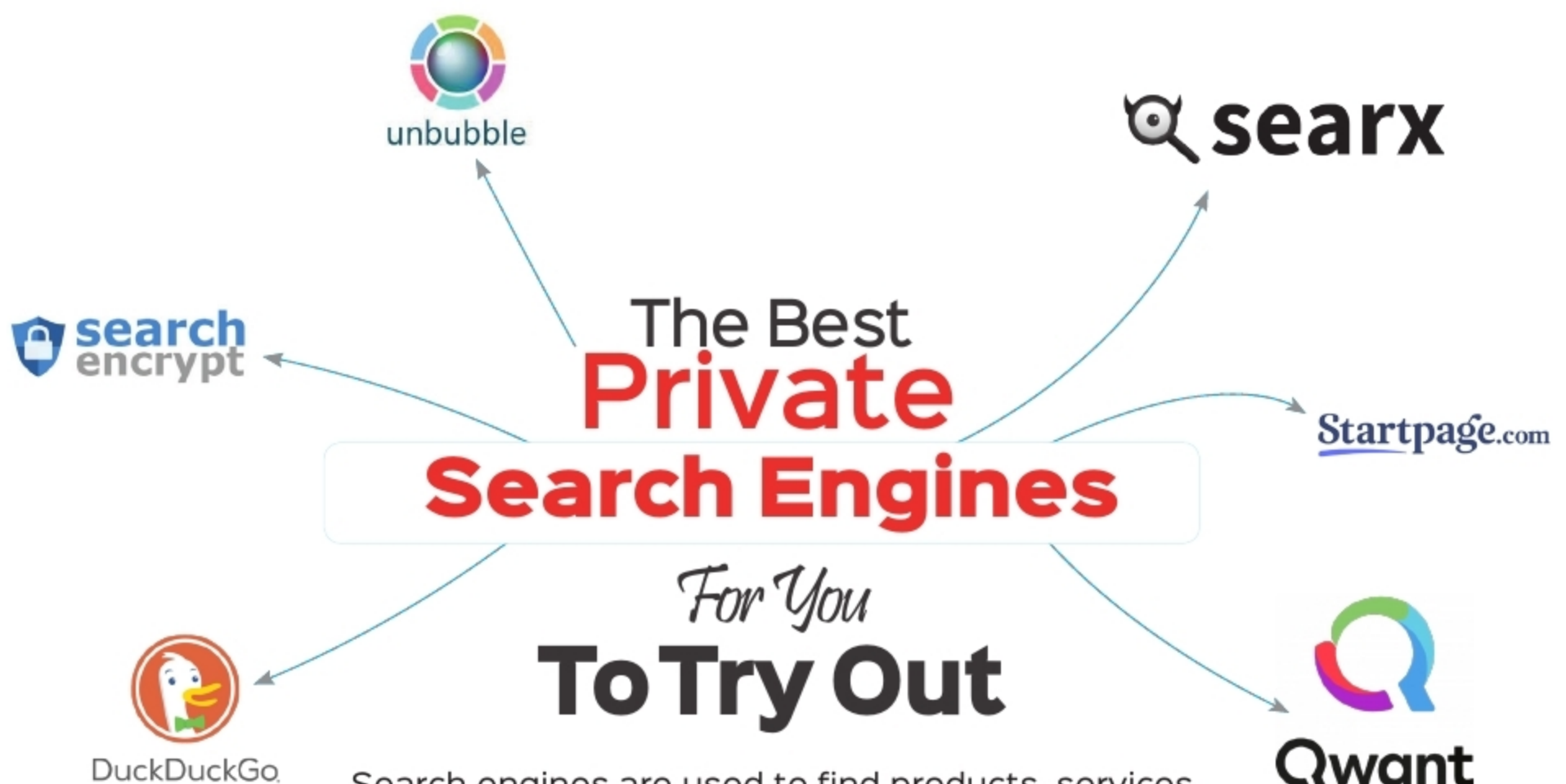




Search engines are used to find products, services or information from the World Wide Web. But many search engines track users and their search keywords to target advertising towards them. Smart search engines sometimes take matters into their own hands and, guided by their analysis of the browsing history, even conceal results from the user. Hence, there is a need for private search engines. Let's take a look at some of the best ones.

Search engines started out merely as tools for finding information on the Internet. But over the years they have evolved considerably, and are producing quicker and smarter results. They also now provide instant answers without you having to go to a website and look for the information. They understand queries well enough and automatically fetch little pieces of information. Search engines can provide various categories of search results, so that users get information on multiple aspects of what they are searching for.

However, there's a darker side to all this that we hardly ever notice, but which is affecting us greatly. For example, some search engines record each search term entered in them and, based on that, they decide what information should be presented to the user and what shouldn't. Sometimes

the information really needed is buried under layers of unnecessary search results, which makes the person searching waste a lot of time.

The need for a private search engine

Privacy has been a hot topic over the past few years. Protecting one's privacy in the real world might not be difficult but in the virtual world it is a whole different game. Many of us don't know how to protect our privacy effectively because we don't have a proper understanding of what needs to be protected on the Internet. As a matter of fact, no one exactly knows how they are tracked online.

Search engines are becoming smarter. Some people have become comfortable with sharing personal information on search engines to get more relevant and accurate results as

quickly as possible. Major Internet companies are engaged in collecting data from their users. They even give a very detailed explanation on what data is collected and how it's used in their 'Privacy Policy' as well as under 'Terms of Service'. But most users aren't concerned about these overreaching terms because they are comfortable with whatever services they are receiving.

Another key privacy concern related to search engines is the advertisements. Some search engines keep showing you the same ad, just because you may have shown interest in the product at some time. Ads can be quite intrusive when they're following you through the Internet. Typically, these types of ads are often pointless and sometimes even out of context. But the existence of these ads implies that the search engines are monitoring your online activity and